

■ COMPLETE ENGLISH EXAM

MEGA STUDY GUIDE

Formality · Levels · Collocations · Idioms · Do/Make · Vocabulary

Zero to Hero — Score 20/20 ■

■ PART 1 — FORMALITY

Definition: Formality refers to how formal or informal your language is. It is determined by the **social distance** between speakers — the more distant or professional the relationship, the more formal the language should be.

What Formality Depends On:

- **Audience** — Who are you talking to? (a professor vs a friend)
- **Setting / Context** — Where is the conversation taking place? (job interview vs a café)
- **Purpose** — Why are you communicating? (applying for a job vs catching up)
- **Medium** — How are you communicating? (formal email vs text message)
- **Relationship** — How close are you to the other person?

What Formality Controls:

Element	Formal Version	Informal Version
Tone	Polite, neutral, respectful	Relaxed, friendly, casual
Word Choice	Longer, sophisticated vocabulary	Short, everyday words
Sentence Length	Longer, complex sentences	Short, simple sentences
Grammar	Strict — always correct	Flexible — mistakes accepted
Contractions	Never (I cannot / I will not)	Always (I can't / I won't)
Phrasal Verbs	Avoided (use: reduce)	Fine (use: cut down on)
Idioms	Avoided	Welcome

Why Formality Matters:

- **Show respect** — Using formal language with a professor shows you respect them
- **Show closeness** — Using informal language with a friend shows you're comfortable
- **Avoid offence** — Being too casual in a job interview could cost you the job
- **Be appropriate** — Language must fit the situation
- **Guide communication** — Formality helps us choose what is appropriate to say

Real-Life Formality Examples:

Situation	Informal	Formal
Can't attend a meeting	"I can't make it today."	"Unfortunately, I will not be able to attend today."
Criticising a plan	"This plan sucks."	"This plan may need some improvement."
Asking for help	"Can you help me out?"	"I would appreciate your assistance."
Saying something is easy	"It's a piece of cake."	"It is extremely straightforward."
Saying you don't know	"I have no clue."	"I am afraid I am not certain."
Asking someone to wait	"Hang on a sec."	"Could you please wait a moment?"
Saying something is expensive	"It costs an arm and a leg."	"It is prohibitively expensive."
Ending an email	"Talk soon!"	"I look forward to hearing from you."

■■ IMPORTANT VOCABULARY TRAP — Confusable Words:

Imminent = happening very soon ("The storm is imminent" / "happens very soon")

Eminent = famous and respected in their field ("an eminent scientist")

Prominent = important, well-known, or standing out ("a prominent politician")

Exerted = applied force or effort ("He exerted pressure")

Recession = economic downturn (period of economic decline)

■ PART 2 — THE 4 LEVELS OF ENGLISH

Level	When to Use	With Whom	Key Features
FORMAL	Academic essays, official letters, presentations, job applications	Professors, managers, strangers, authorities, clients	No contractions, no slang, complex vocabulary, long sentences
SEMI-FORMAL	Professional emails, meetings, presentations to colleagues	Colleagues, someone you respect but know somewhat, business partners	Some contractions OK, polite tone, clear language
INFORMAL	Conversations, casual emails, texting with friends	Friends, family, close classmates	Contractions fine, idioms OK, grammar flexible, slang possible
SLANG	Very casual chat, social media, jokes	Very close friends only	Invented words, very casual, trendy expressions, playful tone

■ FORMAL ENGLISH — Full Rules & Examples

Used for: Academic essays, business letters, job applications, official reports, formal presentations, legal documents.

RULE 1 — Correct Punctuation

Formal writing **MUST** have perfect punctuation. Every sentence ends with a full stop. Commas, colons, and semicolons are used properly.

RULE 2 — Longer, Less Common Words (Avoid Simple Words)

■ Simple / Informal Word	■ Formal / Academic Word
get	obtain / receive / acquire
show	demonstrate / illustrate / indicate
use	utilise / employ
ask	enquire / request
need	require
help	assist / facilitate
think	consider / believe / conclude
find out	discover / ascertain
look at	examine / analyse / investigate
talk about	discuss / address / explore
go up	increase / rise / escalate
go down	decrease / decline / fall
start	commence / initiate / begin
end	conclude / terminate / cease
make better	improve / enhance / optimise
make worse	deteriorate / worsen / exacerbate
very big	substantial / considerable / significant
very small	minimal / negligible / insignificant

RULE 3 — Avoid Phrasal Verbs (Use Single-Word Verbs)

What is a phrasal verb? A phrasal verb = verb + preposition/adverb that has a special meaning.

Example: 'cut down on' = reduce | 'come up with' = devise / generate

In formal English, **ALWAYS** replace phrasal verbs with a single formal verb.

■ Phrasal Verb (Informal)	■ Formal Alternative
cut down on	reduce
put off	postpone / delay

■ Phrasal Verb (Informal)	■ Formal Alternative
find out	discover / determine
set up	establish / create
put up with	tolerate / endure
look into	investigate / examine
come up with	devise / generate / propose
go on	continue / proceed
run out of	exhaust / deplete
hand in	submit
take on	undertake / accept
bring about	cause / produce / generate
carry out	conduct / perform / execute
come across	encounter / discover
go up	increase / rise
go down	decrease / decline
asked for	requested
went up	increased / rose
come back	return

RULE 4 — Avoid Contractions

■ Contraction (Informal)	■ Full Form (Formal)
I can't	I cannot
I won't	I will not
I don't	I do not
I didn't	I did not
I'm	I am
I've	I have
I'd	I would / I had
I'll	I will
it's	it is / it has
they're	they are
we're	we are
you're	you are
that's	that is

■ Contraction (Informal)	■ Full Form (Formal)
there's	there is
doesn't	does not
isn't	is not
aren't	are not
haven't	have not
shouldn't	should not
wouldn't	would not

RULE 5 — Avoid Idioms

Idioms are expressions whose meaning cannot be understood from the individual words. They sound very informal and must be replaced with literal, clear language in formal writing.

■ Idiom (Informal)	■ Formal Alternative
a piece of cake	extremely easy / very straightforward
costs an arm and a leg	is very expensive / is prohibitively costly
hit the nail on the head	is exactly correct / is precisely accurate
once in a blue moon	very rarely / extremely infrequently
under the weather	unwell / feeling ill
bite the bullet	endure a difficult situation
the last straw	the final problem that causes a reaction
break a leg	good luck (this one is NEVER used formally)
as sharp as a tack	highly intelligent / exceptionally astute
won't put up with	will not tolerate

RULE 6 — Avoid Shortened / Abbreviated Words

■ Shortened (Informal)	■ Full Word (Formal)
doc	document / doctor
photo	photograph
info	information
app	application
ad / advert	advertisement
lab	laboratory
exam	examination
gym	gymnasium
phone	telephone

■ Shortened (Informal)	■ Full Word (Formal)
fridge	refrigerator
gonna	going to
wanna	want to
gotta	have to / must
kinda	kind of
sorta	sort of

■ SEMI-FORMAL ENGLISH — Full Rules & Examples

Used for: Emails to colleagues, presentations at work, messages to someone you know but still respect professionally. It's the MIDDLE GROUND.

RULE 1 — Phrasal verbs & contractions CAN be used

Semi-formal OK ✓	Example
Contractions	"I'm writing to let you know..."
Phrasal Verbs	"Please look into this matter."
First person (I/we)	"I would like to discuss..."

RULE 2 — Idioms can be used (carefully)

Common idioms are acceptable in semi-formal settings, but avoid very casual slang. Stick to well-known idioms that everyone understands.

RULE 3 — Use polite English for requests and negative feedback

Situation	Too Blunt (avoid)	Politely Worded (semi-formal)
Making a request	"Do this now."	"Could you please take care of this?"
Saying no	"No, I won't do that."	"I'm afraid that won't be possible."
Negative feedback	"This work is bad."	"There is room for improvement here."
Disagreeing	"That's wrong."	"I'm not sure I agree with that."
Cancelling	"I can't come."	"I'm afraid I won't be able to make it."

■ INFORMAL ENGLISH — Full Features

Used for: Texting friends, casual conversation, social media, talking to people you are close to.

Feature	Description	Example
Short sentences	Grammar is flexible — short and punchy	"See you later!" / "Cool!"
Grammar not critical	Mistakes are tolerated	"Me and him went there."

Feature	Description	Example
Contractions	Always used	"I can't / I'm / it's"
Exclamations	Common	"Wow! / No way! / Seriously?"
Phrasal verbs	Completely fine	"Let's hang out / calm down"
Idioms	Completely fine	"It's a piece of cake!"
First names	Always use first names	"Hey Sarah!"
Questions	Casual questions fine	"Wanna grab coffee?"

■ SLANG — Features & Examples

Used for: Very close friends only. Slang is very casual, playful, trendy and often specific to a generation or region. NEVER use in formal or semi-formal contexts.

Slang Term	Standard English Meaning
Lit / Fire	Excellent / amazing
Slay	To do something very well
Lowkey	Somewhat / secretly
Highkey	Very much / openly
No cap	No lie / I'm serious
Vibe	Feeling / atmosphere
Ghost (someone)	Stop responding / disappear
Tea	Gossip / news
Salty	Bitter / upset about something
Sus	Suspicious
Bet	OK / agreed / sure
Bussin	Delicious / excellent

■ PART 3 — COLLOCATIONS

Definition: A collocation is a combination of words that naturally go together in a language. Native speakers use these combinations automatically. Collocations are NOT always logical — you cannot guess them, you must **LEARN** them.

Why Collocations Matter:

- Using the wrong collocations makes your English sound unnatural even if grammatically correct
- They are a key feature of fluent, advanced English
- They appear in formal writing, business language, and everyday speech
- Phrasal verbs, compound nouns, and adjective+noun pairs are all types of collocations

Core Collocation Examples — CORRECT vs WRONG:

■ Correct Collocation	■ Wrong (sounds unnatural)
She's got blonde hair	~~She's got yellow hair~~
Take a picture	~~Make a picture~~
Make a bet	~~Do a bet~~
Do homework	~~Make homework~~
Make a decision	~~Do a decision~~
Do a favour	~~Make a favour~~
Make progress	~~Do progress~~
Do research	~~Make research~~
Make a mistake	~~Do a mistake~~
Do damage	~~Make damage~~
Make an effort	~~Do an effort~~
Do business	~~Make business~~
Make a speech	~~Do a speech~~
Have a shower	~~Take a shower (British English)~~
Catch a cold	~~Get a cold~~ (both accepted)
Heavy rain	~~Strong rain~~
Strong coffee	~~Heavy coffee~~
Fast food	~~Quick food~~
Broad smile	~~Wide smile~~
Economy drive	~~Economic drive~~

TYPES OF COLLOCATIONS:

Type	Structure	Examples
Verb + Noun	verb collocates with a noun	make a decision, do homework, take a risk
Adjective + Noun	adjective collocates with a noun	heavy rain, strong coffee, broad smile
Noun + Noun (Compound)	two nouns together	stock market, economy drive, family tree
Adverb + Adjective	adverb strengthens adjective	deeply concerned, highly unlikely, utterly exhausted
Verb + Adverb	adverb modifies verb	sleep soundly, think clearly, work hard
Phrasal Verbs	verb + preposition/adverb	come up with, run up, adhere to, go on

STRONG vs WEAK COLLOCATIONS:

Type	Meaning	Key Feature	Examples
STRONG collocation	Word only naturally goes with ONE or very few other words	Cannot be substituted — using another word sounds wrong	blond hair (not 'yellow hair'), rancid butter (not 'bad butter'), commit a crime (not 'do a crime')
WEAK collocation	Word goes with a WIDE range of other words	Many combinations are possible	broad: broad smile, broad spectrum, broad view, broad range, broad topic, broad knowledge

WEAK COLLOCATION — 'BROAD' EXAMPLES:

Broad + ...	Meaning
broad smile	a wide, big smile
broad spectrum	wide range of types / variety of options
broad view	wide perspective
broad range	wide variety
broad topic	a topic covering many areas
broad knowledge	knowledge across many subjects
broad daylight	clearly visible in daytime
broad outline	general overview without details

MITIGATORS vs INTENSIFIERS:

Mitigators = words that WEAKEN or soften the meaning of an adjective

Intensifiers = words that STRENGTHEN or amplify the meaning of an adjective

Category	Words	Example Sentences
MITIGATORS (weaken)	fairly, rather, somewhat, quite, slightly, a bit, a little, pretty	"The crystals are fairly bright." / "I'm rather bored." / "The exam was somewhat difficult." / "She's a bit tired."

Category	Words	Example Sentences
INTENSIFIERS (strengthen)	very, extremely, absolutely, incredibly, highly, utterly, deeply, completely, totally, remarkably, awfully, terribly	"I'm absolutely exhausted." / "She's extremely talented." / "It was utterly impossible." / "He's incredibly smart."

ADVERB + ADJECTIVE COLLOCATIONS (Common in Exams):

Adverb + Adjective	Meaning
deeply concerned	very worried
highly unlikely	very improbable
utterly exhausted	completely tired
bitterly disappointed	very disappointed
perfectly clear	completely clear
widely known	known by many people
heavily involved	very involved
strongly recommend	recommend with conviction
firmly believe	believe very strongly
fully understand	understand completely
barely visible	almost impossible to see
readily available	easy to get / access

MATCHING EXERCISE ANSWERS (from your notes):

Word / Phrase	Collocates With
adhere to	rules / a plan / a principle
arouse	someone's interest / suspicion / curiosity
blend	of wisdom / of flavours
come up with	an economy drive / a solution / an idea
flabby / flimsy	a seminar / argument
fundamentally	contradict / change / different
go on	a seminar / a trip / an economy drive
heavy	the stock market / rain / workload
lead	the stock market / a team
a lick	of paint / of something
play	a suggestion / a role / a part
words	of pain / of wisdom / of advice

COMMON VERB+NOUN COLLOCATIONS:

MAKE	DO	HAVE	TAKE	GET
a decision	homework	a shower	a picture	dressed
a mistake	research	a conversation	a break	married
a speech	a favour	fun	a taxi	promoted
a suggestion	damage	a headache	a risk	fired
progress	business	a good time	medicine	better
an effort	the shopping	trouble	notes	worse
a comment	an exam	a meeting	a seat	lost
a promise	a course	a rest	turns	ready
a complaint	the cooking	a party	a decision	started
an excuse	good	a meal	action	involved

■ PART 4 — DO vs MAKE (Complete Guide)

DO	MAKE
Refers to the ACTION ITSELF	Refers to the RESULT or PRODUCT
Used for: actions, obligations, repetitive tasks	Used for: creating, producing, constructing something
"DO the dishes" (action of washing)	"MAKE a sandwich" (creating food)
"DO your homework" (the task itself)	"MAKE a plan" (producing a plan)

COMPLETE LIST — Things You DO:

DO + ...	DO + ...	DO + ...
do homework	do research	do the washing
do an exam / a test	do a favour	do the cooking
do a course	do business	do the shopping
do a job	do damage	do the ironing
do well / badly	do good	do the dishes
do your hair	do your best	do exercise
do something	do nothing	do a lot
do the right thing	do a degree	do overtime

COMPLETE LIST — Things You MAKE:

MAKE + ...	MAKE + ...	MAKE + ...
make a decision	make a mistake	make a comment
make a speech	make a suggestion	make a complaint
make progress	make an effort	make an excuse
make a plan	make a promise	make a phone call
make a bed	make food / a meal	make money
make a profit / loss	make friends	make an appointment
make a difference	make sense	make a choice
make a pass at (flirt)	make a fuss	make a noise
make a bet	make fun of	make peace
make a request	make a point	make an impression

TRICKY DO vs MAKE — Common Exam Mistakes:

■ Wrong	■ Correct	Remember...
make homework	DO homework	It's a task/action

■ Wrong	■ Correct	Remember...
do a mistake	MAKE a mistake	You create/produce a mistake
do a decision	MAKE a decision	You produce/reach a decision
make research	DO research	Research is an activity/action
do a speech	MAKE a speech	You create a speech
make an exam	DO/TAKE an exam	It's an activity
do progress	MAKE progress	Progress is something you produce
make a favour	DO a favour	A favour is something you do for someone
do noise	MAKE noise	Noise is something you produce
make exercise	DO exercise	Exercise is an activity

SPECIAL EXPRESSIONS with DO and MAKE:

Expression	Meaning	Example
make a pass at someone	flirt with someone	"He made a pass at her at the party."
make a fuss	complain / overreact	"Don't make a fuss about it!"
make a scene	cause a public disturbance	"She made a scene in the restaurant."
make do with	manage with something insufficient	"We'll have to make do with what we have."
do away with	eliminate / abolish	"They did away with the old system."
do without	manage without something	"I can't do without coffee in the morning."
make the most of	use something to best advantage	"Make the most of your time!"
do one's best	try as hard as possible	"I did my best on the exam."

■ PART 5 — IDIOMS (Complete List)

Definition: An idiom is a fixed expression whose meaning CANNOT be understood from the individual words. It has a non-literal (figurative) meaning.

Example: 'a piece of cake' does NOT mean actual cake — it means 'very easy'.

IDIOMS FROM YOUR NOTES & EXERCISES:

Idiom	Meaning	Example Sentence
a piece of cake	very easy	"The test was a piece of cake!"
costs an arm and a leg	very expensive	"That restaurant costs an arm and a leg."
as sharp as a tack	very intelligent	"The new manager is as sharp as a tack."
give someone the creeps	make someone feel uneasy/scared	"That old house gives me the creeps."

Idiom	Meaning	Example Sentence
won't put up with	will not tolerate	"I won't put up with this behaviour."
got canned	got fired from a job	"He got canned after the argument."
from hand to mouth	barely having enough to survive	"They were living from hand to mouth."
hang in there	be patient / keep going / don't give up	"Hang in there — it'll get better!"
set eyes on	see for the first time	"The moment I set eyes on the painting, I loved it."
have a blast	have a great / fun time	"We had a blast at the concert!"
have a hunch	have an intuition / gut feeling	"I have a hunch she'll be late."
a flop	a failure	"The new product was a total flop."
ad campaign is a flop	the advertising campaign failed	"Their ad campaign was a complete flop."
drawing beer	serving beer (work at a bar)	"He was drawing beer all night."
as sharp as a tack (new manager)	very intelligent / quick-witted	"The new manager is as sharp as a tack."
sign up	register / join	"Sign up for the newsletter!"
picks fly	things go wrong / insects swarm	Used in context of things going badly
told him off	scolded / reprimanded someone	"She told him off for being late."
from hand to mouth	barely surviving	"They lived from hand to mouth."
make a pass at / flirt with	show romantic interest	"He made a pass at her."
make a fuss	overreact / complain about small things	"Don't make such a fuss!"
Easier said / sooner said than done	it's harder to do than say	"It's easier said than done."
got canned — short hand	fired — note-taking shorthand	used in your notes
drive a hard bargain	negotiate firmly for the best deal	"She drives a hard bargain."

MORE COMMON IDIOMS (Likely to appear in exam):

Idiom	Meaning
bite the bullet	endure a painful or difficult situation
break the ice	start a conversation / make people feel comfortable
burn the midnight oil	work late into the night
hit the nail on the head	say something exactly right
let the cat out of the bag	accidentally reveal a secret
once in a blue moon	very rarely
under the weather	feeling unwell / sick

Idiom	Meaning
the last straw	the final problem that causes a breakdown
add fuel to the fire	make a bad situation worse
spill the beans	reveal secret information
bite off more than you can chew	take on more than you can handle
cut corners	do something the easy way, sacrificing quality
miss the boat	miss an opportunity
the ball is in your court	it's your turn to take action / decide
take something with a pinch of salt	don't believe something completely
on the fence	undecided / neutral
under the table	secretly / illegally
go back to square one	start again from the beginning
hit the sack	go to sleep
bite the hand that feeds you	hurt someone who helps you

IDIOMS — FORMAL vs INFORMAL Replacements:

Idiom (Informal / Semi-formal only)	Formal Writing Replacement
It's a piece of cake	It is extremely straightforward
Cost an arm and a leg	Are prohibitively expensive
Once in a blue moon	Very rarely / extremely infrequently
Under the weather	Feeling unwell
Hit the nail on the head	Is exactly accurate
On the fence	Undecided / neutral
Go back to square one	Return to the beginning
Bite the bullet	Endure the difficulty
Miss the boat	Miss the opportunity
In a nutshell	To summarise briefly

■ PART 6 — PHRASAL VERBS (Full Guide)

Definition: A phrasal verb = a verb + a preposition or adverb (sometimes both) that creates a meaning DIFFERENT from the original verb.

Example: 'go' + 'on' = 'go on' (meaning: continue) — very different from just 'go'!

Phrasal verbs are a TYPE of collocation.

WHEN TO USE PHRASAL VERBS:

Context	Rule
FORMAL English	AVOID phrasal verbs — use single formal verbs instead
SEMI-FORMAL English	Can be used — but use carefully
INFORMAL English	Freely used — completely natural
Collocations	Phrasal verbs ARE collocations — word combinations

COMPLETE PHRASAL VERB REFERENCE LIST:

Phrasal Verb	Meaning	Formal Alternative
adhere to	follow strictly / stick to	comply with / observe
arouse (someone's interest)	make someone interested	stimulate / generate interest
blend (of wisdom)	combine / mix	combine / merge
come up with	think of / devise	devise / generate / propose
go on	continue / happen	continue / proceed / occur
go on (an economy drive)	start a campaign to save money	implement cost-reduction measures
cut down on	reduce	reduce / decrease
put off	postpone / delay	postpone / defer
find out	discover	discover / ascertain / determine
set up	establish / create	establish / found / create
put up with	tolerate / endure	tolerate / endure
look into	investigate / examine	investigate / examine / analyse
run out of	have no more of	exhaust / deplete
hand in	submit	submit
take on	accept / undertake	undertake / accept
bring about	cause / produce	cause / generate / produce
carry out	perform / do	conduct / perform / execute
come across	find / encounter	encounter / discover
run up	accumulate (a debt/bill)	accumulate / incur

Phrasal Verb	Meaning	Formal Alternative
sign up	register / join	register / enrol
told off	scolded / reprimanded	reprimanded / admonished
set eyes on	see for the first time	encounter / observe
pick up	learn casually / collect	acquire / collect
hang in there	persevere / be patient	persevere / endure
do away with	eliminate / abolish	eliminate / abolish
come across as	appear / seem to be	appear / seem
make do with	manage with limited resources	manage with / cope with
back down	stop arguing / give in	concede / withdraw
back up	support / make a copy of data	support / corroborate
break down	stop working / collapse emotionally	malfunction / collapse
break up	end a relationship / separate	terminate / separate
bring up	raise a topic / raise a child	raise / mention / introduce
call off	cancel	cancel / abandon
check in	register at hotel or airport	register
check out	leave / examine	depart / examine
deal with	handle / manage	manage / handle / address
draw up	write / create a formal document	draft / prepare
figure out	understand / solve	determine / solve / resolve
fill in	complete a form	complete / fill out
get along (with)	have a good relationship	have a positive relationship
give up	stop trying	abandon / discontinue / cease
go ahead	proceed / start	proceed / continue
keep up with	maintain the same pace	maintain / keep pace with
look forward to	anticipate with pleasure	anticipate / await
look up to	admire / respect	admire / respect
make up for	compensate for	compensate / remedy
point out	indicate / mention	indicate / highlight / note
put forward	propose / suggest	propose / suggest / recommend
rule out	eliminate as a possibility	eliminate / exclude
sort out	resolve / organise	resolve / organise / address
stand for	represent / tolerate	represent / symbolise
take over	assume control	assume control / take charge

Phrasal Verb	Meaning	Formal Alternative
turn down	reject / refuse	reject / refuse / decline
work out	exercise / calculate / result in	exercise / calculate / resolve

■ PART 7 — VOCABULARY: TYPES OF PEOPLE

These vocabulary words appeared in your crossword exercises. Know the DEFINITION of each word AND be able to explain it in English (as the crossword exercise required).

SOCIAL TYPES — Definitions:

Word	Definition	Key Detail
Neighbour	A person who lives next to you or very close to you	Lives nearby — not necessarily a friend
Colleague	A person you work with in the same organization	Professional relationship at work
Acquaintance	Someone you know slightly — not a close friend	You know them, but not well
Partner	A person you work with OR live with (romantic or business)	Could be business or romantic
Opponent	A person who competes against you or disagrees with you	Someone on the other side
Predecessor	The person who previously held a role or position before you	Came BEFORE you in the job
Successor	The person who takes over a role or position after you	Comes AFTER you in the job
Aristocrat	A person from a noble family of high social class	Born into privilege / nobility
Celebrity	A famous and well-known person (often in entertainment)	Fame is the key idea
Hermit	A person who lives alone and avoids society	Lives in isolation, avoids people
Orphan	A child whose parents have both died	Child WITHOUT parents
Pedestrian	A person who is travelling on foot (walking)	Not in a vehicle — on foot
Bachelor	An unmarried man	Single male, not married
Spinster	An older unmarried woman (now considered old-fashioned)	Single female, not married (older term)
Vegetarian	A person who does not eat meat or fish	Diet-based lifestyle choice
Witness	A person who sees an event, especially a crime or accident	Sees something happen
Stowaway	A person who hides on a vehicle (ship/plane) to travel for free	Hides to travel without paying
Refugee	A person who flees their country due to war, persecution or disaster	Forced to leave their home country
Hooligan	A violent, rowdy, anti-social young person	Causes trouble / violence
Gangster	A member of a criminal gang	Involved in organised crime
Deserter	A soldier who abandons their duty and flees from the military	Leaves military without permission

Word	Definition	Key Detail
Heir	A person who will legally inherit property or a title	Will receive something after death
Midwife	A trained professional who assists women during childbirth	Helps deliver babies
Genius	A person of exceptionally high intelligence or talent	Extraordinarily smart or talented
Tourist	A person who travels to places for pleasure and sightseeing	Travels for fun, not work
Client	A person who uses the services of a professional (lawyer, designer, etc.)	Professional service customer
Accomplice	A person who helps another commit a crime	Helper in a crime
Chatterbox	A person who talks too much and constantly	Can't stop talking
Acquaintance	Someone you know but not closely	Casual social connection

PROFESSIONS — Definitions (Group B Crossword Words):

Profession	What They Do	Where They Work
Architect	Designs buildings and structures	Architecture firm / office
Barber	Cuts men's hair	Barber shop
Dustman (Bin man)	Collects rubbish / garbage from homes	On the streets / rubbish trucks
Farmer	Grows crops and/or raises animals for food	Farm / fields
Journalist	Researches, writes and reports news stories	Newspaper / TV / online
Miner	Works underground extracting coal or minerals	Mine / underground
Nurse	Provides medical care and assists doctors with patients	Hospital / clinic
Pilot	Operates and flies aircraft	Cockpit of an aircraft
Salesman	Sells products or services to customers	Shops / offices / door-to-door
Secretary	Provides administrative and organisational support	Office
Traffic warden	Enforces parking regulations	Streets / car parks
Carpenter	Works with wood to build furniture and structures	Workshop / construction sites
Butcher	Prepares and sells meat products	Butcher shop
Chef	Professionally trained cook who prepares meals in restaurants	Restaurant / hotel kitchen
Dentist	Examines and treats teeth and oral health	Dental surgery / clinic
Hairdresser	Cuts, colours and styles hair	Hair salon
Librarian	Manages and organises books in a library	Library

Profession	What They Do	Where They Work
Vet (Veterinarian)	Diagnoses and treats illnesses in animals	Veterinary clinic
Waiter / Waitress	Serves food and drink to customers	Restaurant / café
Actor	Performs roles in films, theatre or TV	Film set / theatre / TV studio
Baker	Makes and sells bread, cakes and pastries	Bakery
Doctor	Diagnoses and treats human illnesses and injuries	Hospital / GP surgery

GROUP A CROSSWORD — Other Professions:

Profession	What They Do
Aristocrat	Member of the highest social class / nobility
Bachelor	Unmarried man
Celebrity	Famous person
Colleague	Person you work with
Hermit	Person who lives alone in isolation
Neighbour	Person who lives near you
Orphan	Child with no parents
Pedestrian	Person travelling on foot
Refugee	Person fleeing danger/persecution
Spinster	Unmarried woman (old-fashioned term)
Stowaway	Person hiding on transport to travel free
Successor	Person who follows in a role
Vegetarian	Person who doesn't eat meat
Witness	Person who sees an event

GROUP B ADDITIONAL — More People Words:

Word	Meaning
accomplice	helper in committing a crime
acquaintance	someone you know slightly
chatterbox	someone who talks constantly
client	customer of a professional service
deserter	soldier who flees duty
gangster	criminal gang member
genius	person of exceptional intelligence
heir	person who will inherit

Word	Meaning
hooligan	violent/rowdy troublemaker
midwife	assists in childbirth
opponent	person competing against you
partner	business or romantic companion
predecessor	person who came before in a role
tourist	person travelling for pleasure

■ PART 8 — COMPARATIVES & SUPERLATIVES

Type of Adjective	Comparative Rule	Superlative Rule	Example
SHORT (1 syllable)	Add -er	Add -est	nice → nicer → nicest tall → taller → tallest
SHORT ending in -e	Add -r	Add -st	large → larger → largest
SHORT ending in CVC (consonant-vowel-consonant)	Double final consonant + -er	Double final consonant + -est	big → bigger → biggest hot → hotter → hottest
SHORT ending in -y	Change y → i + -er	Change y → i + -est	happy → happier → happiest
LONG (2+ syllables)	Use 'more'	Use 'most'	beautiful → more beautiful → most beautiful interesting → more interesting
IRREGULAR	Special forms — must memorise!	Special forms — must memorise!	good → better → best bad → worse → worst far → farther/further → farthest/furthest much/many → more → most little → less → least

SYLLABLE RULE (from your notes):

If an adjective has **more than 3 syllables**, ALWAYS use 'more' (never add -er).
 Example: 'beautiful' (3 syllables) → 'more beautiful' (NOT beautifuler!)
 Short adjective example: 'nice' (1 syllable) → 'nicer'

COMMON IRREGULAR COMPARATIVES TO MEMORISE:

Base Adjective	Comparative	Superlative
good	better	best
bad	worse	worst
far	farther / further	farthest / furthest
much / many	more	most
little	less	least
old	older / elder (for people)	oldest / eldest (for people)

■ PART 9 — POLITE ENGLISH (Requests & Negative Feedback)

Polite English is essential in **semi-formal** and **formal** contexts. It is used to make requests sound less direct and to give negative feedback without offending.

MAKING POLITE REQUESTS:

Direct (Rude/Blunt)	Polite Version	Level
"Do this now."	"Could you please do this?"	Semi-formal
"I want the report."	"I was wondering if you could send me the report."	Formal

Direct (Rude/Blunt)	Polite Version	Level
"Help me."	"Would you mind helping me?"	Semi-formal / Formal
"Tell me the answer."	"I would appreciate it if you could tell me the answer."	Formal
"Give me feedback."	"I would be grateful for your feedback."	Formal
"Fix this mistake."	"Could you possibly have a look at this?"	Semi-formal

GIVING POLITE NEGATIVE FEEDBACK:

Blunt Version	Polite / Diplomatic Version
"This is wrong."	"There seems to be a slight issue here."
"This work is bad."	"There is certainly room for improvement."
"You made a mistake."	"I think there may be a small error."
"I don't like this idea."	"I'm not entirely convinced by this approach."
"This is terrible."	"This doesn't quite meet the requirements."
"You're wrong."	"I'm not sure I agree with that perspective."

■ PART 10 — EXTRA VOCABULARY FROM NOTES

Word / Phrase	Type	Meaning
exerted	verb (past)	applied effort or force (e.g. 'He exerted pressure')
recession	noun	a period of economic decline / downturn
imminent	adjective	about to happen very soon
eminent	adjective	famous and respected in a field
prominent	adjective	important, well-known, or standing out clearly
competition	noun	a contest between rivals for something
feedback	noun	comments/opinions about performance or work
syllable	noun	a unit of pronunciation (e.g. 'cat' = 1, 'beautiful' = 3)
mitigator	noun	a word that weakens/softens meaning (fairly, rather)
intensifier	noun	a word that strengthens meaning (very, extremely)
collocation	noun	words that naturally go together
phrasal verb	noun	verb + preposition/adverb = new meaning
contraction	noun	two words joined with an apostrophe (I'm, can't)
idiom	noun	an expression with a non-literal meaning
formal	adjective	official, serious, following rules
informal	adjective	casual, relaxed, everyday
semi-formal	adjective	between formal and informal

Word / Phrase	Type	Meaning
slang	noun	very casual/playful language, often trendy
preposition verb / prepositional verb	noun	verb + preposition (ask for, depend on)
social distance	noun	the degree of closeness/familiarity between people
paramount importance	collocation	of the greatest / highest importance
of great importance	collocation	very important
broad spectrum	collocation	wide range of types or varieties
make a pass at	idiom / expression	to flirt with someone
make a fuss	expression	to complain or get upset about something minor
have a blast	idiom	to have a great, enjoyable time
have a hunch	idiom	to have a gut feeling or intuition about something
modesty notice event	vocabulary	terms seen in context of your notes

■ PART 11 — WRITING EXAM TIPS

If your exam has a writing section, use these strategies to get maximum marks.

CHECKLIST FOR FORMAL WRITING:

■ Check	What to look for
No contractions	Replace I'm → I am, Can't → Cannot, etc.
No phrasal verbs	Replace: cut down on → reduce, find out → discover
No idioms	Replace: a piece of cake → very easy
No shortened words	Replace: doc → document, info → information
Formal vocabulary	Use: obtain, demonstrate, require, facilitate
Long sentences	Connect ideas with: however, furthermore, in addition
Polite tone	No direct demands — use 'could you', 'I would appreciate'
Correct punctuation	Check full stops, commas, capital letters
Formal greeting/closing	Dear Mr/Ms... Yours sincerely Yours faithfully
Passive voice (optional)	Use passive: 'It has been decided...' instead of 'We decided...'

LINKING WORDS BY FUNCTION:

Function	Linking Words / Phrases
Adding information	Furthermore, In addition, Moreover, Also, Besides
Contrasting	However, Nevertheless, On the other hand, Although, Despite
Giving reasons	Because, Since, As, Due to, Owing to
Showing result	Therefore, Consequently, As a result, Thus, Hence
Giving examples	For example, For instance, Such as, Namely
Concluding	In conclusion, To summarise, Overall, In summary
Sequencing	Firstly, Secondly, Subsequently, Finally, Lastly

■ MEGA CHEAT SHEET — Everything at a Glance

■ **FORMALITY** = tone + word choice. Depends on: audience, setting, purpose, relationship.

■ **FORMAL**: No contractions ✗ | No phrasal verbs ✗ | No idioms ✗ | No slang ✗ | Long vocabulary ✓

■ **SEMI-FORMAL**: Contractions OK ✓ | Phrasal verbs OK ✓ | Idioms OK ✓ | Polite tone always ✓

■ **INFORMAL**: Short sentences ✓ | Grammar flexible ✓ | Anything goes ✓

■ **SLANG**: Close friends only. Very casual, trendy, playful.

■ **COLLOCATIONS**: Words that naturally go together. NOT always logical. Must be LEARNT.

■ STRONG collocation: word only goes with 1-2 others (blonde hair, NOT yellow hair)
■ WEAK collocation: word goes with many others (broad smile / spectrum / view / range)
■ MITIGATORS: weaken meaning → fairly, rather, slightly, somewhat, a bit
■ INTENSIFIERS: strengthen meaning → very, extremely, absolutely, utterly, deeply
■ DO = the action itself (do homework, do research, do a favour, do damage)
■ MAKE = creating / producing (make a decision, make a mistake, make progress, make a speech)
■ IDIOMS: Fixed expressions with NON-LITERAL meanings. Avoid in formal writing.
■ PHRASAL VERBS: verb + preposition = new meaning. AVOID in formal English.
■ COMPARATIVES: short adjectives → -er (nicer) long adjectives → more (more beautiful)
■ IMMINENT = very soon EMINENT = famous PROMINENT = well-known / standing out
■ CONTRACTIONS: NEVER in formal writing. Always write the full form.
■ POLITE REQUESTS: 'Could you...?' / 'Would you mind...?' / 'I would appreciate...'

■ You've studied **EVERYTHING**. Walk into that exam with **CONFIDENCE**. Score **20/20!** ■